

Oregon House District 27: 2026 Voter Guide

Mark Norman & Tammy Carpenter

A Side-by-Side Look at the Candidates and the Issues

TAXES

HEALTHCARE

HOUSING

EDUCATION

PUBLIC SAFETY

ECONOMIC GROWTH

More government requires more taxpayer funding.

Compare what each candidate proposes and how
those proposals would be funded.



MARK NORMAN

GENERAL ELECTION • NOVEMBER 3, 2026^[6]

Beaverton • West Slope • Cedar Hills • Cedar Mill • Washington County

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An Open Seat. Two Different Approaches.

Oregon House District 27 will elect a new representative in November 2026.

The candidates (Mark Norman and Tammy Carpenter) bring different professional backgrounds, and significantly different ideas about taxes, healthcare, housing, education, public safety, and government's role in Oregon's economy.

Meet the Candidates

MARK NORMAN

Navy Veteran • Veterinarian • Small-Business Owner

Norman's background includes decades of military service, veterinary medicine and small-business experience.

His approach starts with a simple principle:

Government should live within its means and prove that what it spends actually works.

Norman wants to:

- Control state spending
- Oppose unnecessary taxes and fees
- Reduce barriers to housing
- Support small businesses and jobs
- Focus schools on academic achievement
- Strengthen public safety
- Demand measurable results from government programs

His campaign emphasizes affordability, education and government accountability.^[1]

TAMMY CARPENTER

Beaverton School Board Member • Democratic Socialist • DSA Member

Carpenter identifies herself as a democratic socialist. She joined Democratic Socialists of America in 2016 and describes DSA as her political home.^[2]

Her published agenda would expand government spending, financing or regulation across several major areas:

- **Healthcare:** Statewide government run healthcare
- **Housing:** Statewide renter regulation and social housing
- **Education:** Massive taxpayer investment across preschool, K-12 and higher education
- **Childcare:** Expanded government-funded childcare programs
- **Energy/Transportation:** Major state spending on transit and Green New Deal policies

For these, additional tax revenue is required for financing.

Carpenter says Oregon should "tax the rich" and says major corporations such as Nike and Intel should pay more to finance government services.^{[2][7]}

THE FINANCING QUESTION

How much additional government spending would these commitments require, and how would Oregon raise the money?

More Government Programs Require More Taxpayer Funding.

The candidates begin from substantially different assumptions about what state government should do and how it should pay for those responsibilities.

ISSUE	MARK NORMAN	TAMMY CARPENTER
Taxes	Oppose unnecessary tax/fee increases and control spending	Higher taxes on wealthy Oregonians to finance expanded government programs
Healthcare	Opposes Oregon government-run healthcare	Statewide government-financed universal healthcare requiring substantial government financing
Housing	Reduce barriers so more housing can be built	Statewide renter regulation + taxpayer-funded social housing
Education	Fundamentals, standards and measurable results	Massive taxpayer investment on education
Public Safety/ICE	Law enforcement + treatment + accountability	Sanctuary protections + “Abolish ICE”
Data Centers	Keep Oregon competitive for investment	Three-year moratorium on data-center expansion
Government	Limited, accountable and measured by results	Democratic socialist approach involving greater government spending/regulation across major sectors
Childcare	—	Expanded government-funded childcare programs. Carpenter says she plans to introduce a wealth tax to fund childcare and schools

Voters must ask:

01

What would each proposal cost?

02

How would it be financed?

03

What responsibilities should government assume?

Candidate positions are based primarily on the candidates’ own published platforms.

Expanding Government Programs Requires Money.

MARK NORMAN

Control spending before asking taxpayers for more.

Norman says tax reduction is his number one priority.^[1]

He wants to:

- Control state spending
- Oppose unnecessary tax and fee increases
- Demand measurable results from government programs
- Reduce policies that drive up everyday costs
- Help small businesses remain viable
- Let families keep more of what they earn^[1]

His argument is simple:

If Oregon is already becoming harder to afford, adding new taxes and fees isn't the answer.

TAMMY CARPENTER

Expand government. Increase taxes on wealthy Oregonians.

Carpenter proposes additional government spending or intervention in healthcare, education, childcare, housing, transportation and other areas.

She explicitly calls on the Legislature to tax the rich. Her education platform also says companies should pay more.^{[2][7]}

THE MAIN QUESTION IS HOW THE MATH WORKS.

New or expanded government programs require funding.

“Free at the Point of Service” Still Has a Cost.

Government-financed healthcare still has to be financed.

Carpenter supports moving Oregon toward a statewide Universal Health Plan.

Her campaign describes a comprehensive system covering Oregonians without copays and making healthcare free at the point of service^[8] but this government-run healthcare system would require a financing mechanism to pay for the cost of care.

Oregon’s Universal Health Plan Governance Board has examined financing concepts including:^[3]

10.1%

Proposed Healthcare
Personal Income Tax

9.6%

Proposed Employer Payroll
Tax

+3.0 pts

Proposed Corporate Income
Tax increase

+0.10 pts

Proposed Corporate Activity
Tax increase

Important: These are financing concepts examined by Oregon’s Universal Health Plan Governance Board. They are not currently imposed taxes and are not Tammy Carpenter’s personal tax proposal.^{[3][4]}

MARK NORMAN

Norman rejects a government-run healthcare system.

He favors reforms centered on affordability, access, transparency, patient choice and provider support. His campaign explicitly says he does not support a government-run single-payer system for Oregon.

TAMMY CARPENTER

Carpenter wants Oregon to move in the opposite direction.

Her campaign says Oregon should pass a Universal Health Plan and make medicine free at the point of service.^[8] A statewide universal healthcare system would require substantial government financing.

The danger is calling healthcare “free” while ignoring the taxes required to pay for it.

There is no free healthcare. There is only a decision about who pays.

Oregon Already Regulates Rent. Tammy Carpenter Wants Government to Go Further.

Housing affordability is a serious problem.

But more government control is not automatically more affordable housing.

TAMMY CARPENTER

Greater government involvement and regulation

Carpenter supports taking statewide a Renters' Bill of Rights that includes six months' notice for rent increases, additional eviction restrictions, legal representation in eviction proceedings and linking rent costs to minimum wage. Her campaign also promotes statewide rent control.^{[2][8]}

And she doesn't stop there.

She has also advocated government-run social housing, including cooperative and city/county-managed housing.^[7] That would increase government's role in both housing regulation and housing provision.

MARK NORMAN

Reduce the cost and barriers to building

Norman emphasizes reducing barriers that make housing more expensive or difficult to construct.^[1]

His approach relies more heavily on increasing housing production rather than expanding government involvement in housing.

The risk is straightforward:

- ! More restrictions can increase pressure on housing providers.
- ! Government-managed housing puts taxpayers on the hook.
- ! Policies that discourage private investment can make it harder, not easier, to add the housing Oregon desperately needs.

THE POLICY DIFFERENCE

Build more housing or put more housing decisions in government's hands?

Education and Childcare: How Much Should Government Provide?

Both candidates identify education as important.

Their disagreement concerns spending, structure and results.

MARK NORMAN

Norman emphasizes:

- Reading
- Math
- Science
- Career readiness
- Academic standards
- Parent involvement
- Student achievement

His benchmark: Are students learning?

TAMMY CARPENTER

Carpenter calls for massive taxpayer investment across preschool, K-12, community colleges, public universities and trade schools. She is in favor of greater government-run education and childcare but the question remains the same. **Who pays?**

She has also discussed a wealth tax as a financing source for childcare and schools.^[7] But what measurable results should taxpayers expect?

SPENDING AND OUTCOMES ARE DIFFERENT MEASURES.

The policy question is

How much additional investment is needed?

Public Safety, Immigration and the DSA Question

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Norman supports:

- Recruiting and retaining qualified officers
- Fully funded public safety
- Holding offenders accountable
- Community policing
- Behavioral-health partnerships
- Addiction treatment^[1]

TAMMY CARPENTER

Carpenter supports Oregon's Sanctuary Promise Act.

Her published immigration platform concludes with:

"ABOLISH ICE!"^[2]

Carpenter also identifies herself as a DSA member and describes DSA as her political home.^[2]

National DSA's program separately advocates major changes to policing and incarceration, including redirecting police funding as steps toward police and prison abolition.

That is what the organization advocates, but Tammy Carpenter's own positions and DSA's national positions should not be treated as interchangeable.

Jobs and Investment, or a Three-Year Moratorium?

Washington County is a center of technology and infrastructure investment.

Data centers create legitimate questions about electricity, water, land use and tax incentives. Those problems deserve solutions. **But Carpenter wants a moratorium.**

TAMMY CARPENTER

On August 5, 2026, Carpenter joined Democratic legislators and candidates calling for a three-year moratorium on large-scale data-center development in Oregon.^[5]

Her own platform also calls for a moratorium on data-center expansion in Washington County.^[2]

MARK NORMAN

Norman's economic approach emphasizes keeping Oregon affordable for employers, supporting small businesses and avoiding policies that drive jobs and investment elsewhere.

The danger of a blanket moratorium is simple: investment can go somewhere else. Oregon can address infrastructure problems without putting up a three-year stop sign for major development.

Solve the problems, or shut down the investment?

Five Questions Before You Vote

- ✓ Which candidate's approach to taxes best reflects your household priorities?
- ✓ Which healthcare model do you believe is more sustainable?
- ✓ How should Oregon increase housing affordability?
- ✓ What should schools prioritize to improve student outcomes?
- ✓ What balance should Oregon strike between economic development, public services and regulation?

The differences bring clarity. The decision belongs to District 27 voters.

Carpenter Is a DSA Member. What Does National DSA Advocate?

The national DSA program separately advocates policies including:

PUBLIC SAFETY & IMMIGRATION

Police/prison abolition policies • Abolish ICE • Broad legalization and citizenship pathways

ECONOMY

Public ownership of major corporations and essential industries • Aggressive wealth and corporate taxation

HOUSING & HEALTHCARE

Publicly owned social housing • Universal rent control • Universal healthcare without individual charges

FEDERAL GOVERNMENT

Abolish the Electoral College • Abolish the U.S. Senate • Replace the President and Supreme Court with an executive and judiciary chosen by and subordinate to Congress • Restructure the federal judiciary/Supreme Court under Congress

Important distinction: These are positions of the national Democratic Socialists of America. DSA membership alone does not establish that Carpenter personally endorses every national proposal.

MARK NORMAN'S PUBLISHED APPROACH

- Lower taxes and fees.
- Controlled spending.
- Private-sector housing growth.
- Strong public safety.
- Academic fundamentals.
- Economic investment.
- Government measured by results.

The danger isn't the word "socialism."

It's giving government more control while asking taxpayers to finance every new promise.

Look beyond the slogans.

Ask what it costs.

Ask who pays.

Ask how much control government gets.

The Choice Belongs to District 27.

LEARN MORE ABOUT MARK NORMAN →
markfororegon.com

STAY INFORMED ABOUT HOUSE DISTRICT 27 →
northwestoregon.com

Information and candidate positions reviewed as of September 14, 2026. See Sources & References for details.

Sources & References

- [1] Mark Norman for Oregon – Campaign Website
- [2] Tammy Carpenter for Oregon House District 27 – “What I Stand For”
- [3] Oregon Universal Health Plan Governance Board – March 19, 2026 Presentation
- [4] Oregon Universal Health Plan Governance Board – 2026 Focus Group Materials
- [5] Tammy Carpenter Campaign
- [6] BallotReady – Oregon General Election, November 3, 2026
- [7] Oregon House 27th District: Beaverton | Voter Guide 2026
- [8] Tammy Carpenter for Oregon House District 27 – Campaign

Information and candidate positions reviewed as of September 14, 2026. Candidate positions, campaign materials, websites and policy proposals may change after publication.

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